

MedCore Hospitals & Healthcare Services Pvt. Ltd.

Leave & Attendance Policy

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1. Purpose and Policy Principles

This policy establishes the operating rules for attendance recording, work schedules, leave requests, absence reporting, approvals, attendance corrections and return-to-work administration at MedCore Hospitals. It is intended to provide a consistent process while allowing clinical and operational functions to use rosters appropriate to their service requirements.

Attendance and leave are maintained as separate but connected records. Attendance reflects whether an employee was scheduled and recorded as working, absent, on an approved assignment or otherwise covered by an authorized status. Leave records describe approved time away from scheduled work. An employee should therefore not assume that an attendance entry will be changed simply because a leave request has been submitted.

The policy is administered by HR & Administration with responsibilities shared by employees, reporting managers, roster owners and payroll. Where an employment contract or appointment document provides a specific term, that document governs the individual employment relationship. This policy supplies the standard internal framework for the fictional MedCore organization.

2. Applicability and Definitions

The policy applies to permanent employees, probationary employees and fixed-term employees unless their appointment terms establish a different arrangement. Trainees, interns and approved contractual personnel follow the attendance and absence conditions stated in their engagement documents, with this policy used where those documents refer to the MedCore attendance process.

For this policy, the following terms have specific administrative meanings:

- **Attendance day:** a calendar day on which an employee is scheduled to work or is required to report under an approved roster.
- **Scheduled hours:** the working hours assigned through the employee's administrative schedule or approved roster.
- **Leave:** an approved period during which the employee is not required to perform scheduled work.
- **Unplanned absence:** an absence that could not reasonably be requested in advance, such as sudden illness or an urgent personal event.
- **Attendance correction:** a request to amend an attendance record where the recorded status does not match the approved schedule or actual attendance.
- **Leave balance:** the remaining amount of an applicable leave category available to an employee at a given point in the leave year.
- **Roster owner:** the manager or designated administrator responsible for publishing and maintaining a team's operational schedule.

A manager may use different shift labels or local scheduling terminology, but the underlying record must identify the employee, date, scheduled period and approved status clearly enough for HR and payroll reconciliation.

3. Work Schedules and Roster Administration

MedCore uses different scheduling arrangements because hospital services operate beyond a single administrative day. The standard administrative schedule for this framework is 9:30 a.m. to 6:00 p.m., Monday to Friday, with a one-hour break. Clinical, facilities, security, IT operations and other service teams may use approved shifts, including weekends or overnight coverage, where required.

A roster should be published sufficiently in advance for employees to understand their scheduled days and reporting times. The roster owner is responsible for ensuring that changes are visible to affected employees. An employee should not rely on an informal verbal change when the official roster has not been updated.

Roster changes should follow these controls:

- A shift change requested by an employee requires approval from the designated roster owner before the change is treated as authorized.
- A manager-initiated change should be communicated to the affected employee and reflected in the approved scheduling record.
- Employees should not exchange shifts directly if the change would create a staffing, safety or compliance issue.
- A roster change that affects payroll, overtime or leave treatment should be communicated to HR or the designated attendance administrator.
- Emergency operational changes may be made immediately by authorized managers, with the attendance record updated after the immediate operational need has been addressed.

4. Attendance Recording and Daily Controls

Employees are responsible for recording attendance through the designated attendance system or approved local mechanism. The employee should check that the record reflects the correct date and status. Where the system requires both an entry and exit record, both must be completed unless an approved exception applies.

Attendance credentials are individual. Employees must never record attendance for another person, lend attendance credentials or ask a colleague to create a false attendance record. A genuine system failure should be reported rather than bypassed through an unofficial record.

Situation	Employee action	Manager / HR action
Normal workday	Record attendance using the designated system and review obvious errors.	Monitor exceptions and approve required corrections.
Missed punch	Submit an attendance-correction request with the actual reporting and leaving details.	Validate against roster, work evidence or manager confirmation.
System outage	Inform the manager or attendance administrator and use the instructed contingency process.	Record the outage-related exception and reconcile the system later.
Wrong roster	Report the discrepancy before it affects payroll or leave treatment where practical.	Verify the approved schedule and update the controlled roster.
Proxy attendance	Do not participate; report suspected misuse through the appropriate channel.	Refer suspected falsification for review under applicable processes.

5. Attendance Exceptions, Late Arrival and Early Departure

Occasional delays can occur because of transport disruption, operational requirements or other circumstances. Employees should communicate a likely delay to the reporting manager as soon as reasonably possible rather than waiting until the scheduled start time has passed. Communication does not automatically convert a late arrival into approved leave.

For administrative employees, arrival after the scheduled start time is recorded as late unless the manager approves a schedule adjustment or another authorized status. For shift employees, lateness is measured against the employee's published roster rather than the administrative schedule.

The following treatment applies to recurring attendance exceptions:

- A single minor discrepancy may be resolved through an attendance correction or manager confirmation where appropriate.
- Repeated late arrivals or early departures may be reviewed by the manager to determine whether there is a scheduling, conduct or performance issue.

- Where an employee leaves early because of illness or an urgent event, the employee should notify the manager and record the applicable leave or authorized absence status.
- Managers should not routinely use informal messages as a substitute for the official attendance record.
- Attendance patterns should be reviewed using the actual record rather than assumptions based on isolated incidents.

6. Leave Year, Categories and Standard Entitlements

The MedCore leave year runs from 1 April to 31 March. Leave is administered according to employee category and applicable eligibility. The following standard entitlements form the baseline used for the MedCore dataset. Individual appointment terms or approved policy exceptions may provide different treatment.

Leave category	Standard entitlement	Primary use	Carry-forward
Earned / Privilege Leave (EL)	18 days per leave year	Planned personal, family or other approved absence.	Up to 12 days
Casual Leave (CL)	8 days per leave year	Short-duration personal matters and unforeseen needs.	Not carried forward
Sick Leave (SL)	10 days per leave year	Illness, recovery or medically advised absence.	Not carried forward
Compassionate Leave	Up to 3 working days per event	Death or critical bereavement involving an immediate family member.	Not applicable
Leave Without Pay (LWP)	No fixed entitlement	Approved absence when paid leave is unavailable or not applicable.	Not applicable

Leave balances are maintained in the HR system. The balance shown by the system is the starting point for approval, but an employee should not assume that every available day can be taken without considering staffing requirements, notice rules or the minimum application conditions for the particular leave category.

7. Earned / Privilege Leave

Earned Leave is intended primarily for planned absence. The standard annual entitlement is 18 working days. It accrues monthly at 1.5 days for each completed month of eligible service. The system may show a prorated balance for employees joining partway through the leave year.

An employee should normally submit an Earned Leave request at least seven calendar days before the intended start date. Longer notice may be required for extended absence or periods identified by the department as operationally critical. A manager may consider workload, staffing and prior approved leave when reviewing the request.

Up to 12 unused Earned Leave days may be carried into the following leave year. Any balance above the permitted carry-forward limit is treated according to the year-end rules configured by HR. Employees should review their balance before the end of the leave year rather than assuming that unused days will automatically remain available.

8. Casual and Short-Duration Leave

Casual Leave provides flexibility for short personal requirements that do not justify extended planned leave. The standard entitlement is 8 days per leave year. Casual Leave is not carried forward. A request should normally be submitted before the absence; where that is not practical, the employee must notify the manager at the earliest reasonable opportunity and complete the record after returning.

Casual Leave should not be used to conceal repeated attendance problems or to retrospectively regularize an absence without explanation. Managers may request clarification where a pattern of last-minute requests affects staffing or creates a repeated mismatch between rostered work and recorded attendance.

Casual Leave administration rules:

- It is normally approved in whole-day units; half-day use may be permitted where the HR system supports it and the manager approves.
- It cannot be used to create a negative balance unless HR has expressly approved an exception.

- Unused Casual Leave expires at the end of the leave year.
- Where an absence continues beyond the available Casual Leave balance, the employee must use another applicable category or obtain approval for LWP.

9. Sick Leave and Medical Absence

Sick Leave is intended for an employee's illness, recovery or medically advised inability to work. The standard entitlement is 10 working days per leave year and unused Sick Leave does not carry forward.

An employee who becomes unwell unexpectedly should inform the reporting manager as soon as reasonably possible, preferably before the scheduled start time. The employee should then record the absence through the HR or attendance system. If the employee is unable to submit the request personally, a manager or authorized HR administrator may record the initial absence, with the employee completing the supporting process when reasonably able.

A medical certificate may be required for an absence exceeding two consecutive working days, or where HR reasonably requires supporting documentation for repeated or exceptional absences. The document should be submitted through the approved HR channel and should contain only the information necessary for leave administration.

Where a medical restriction affects the employee's ability to perform normal duties, the employee should inform HR so that the appropriate workplace process can be considered. The leave record should distinguish approved absence from any separate return-to-work or work-adjustment arrangement.

10. Emergency Absence and Unplanned Leave

An unplanned absence is one where advance notice was not reasonably possible. Examples include sudden illness, an urgent family matter, a serious transport disruption or another unexpected event requiring immediate attention. The employee should contact the reporting manager through the designated communication channel and provide an estimated duration where known.

The employee should not mark an absence as approved merely because a message was sent. Approval and record completion remain subject to the applicable leave category and manager/HR review.

For an unplanned absence, the expected sequence is:

- Notify the reporting manager as early as reasonably possible.
- State the date of absence and, where known, the expected return date.
- Use the HR/attendance system to submit the applicable leave or absence request when able.
- Provide supporting evidence where the policy or HR process requires it.
- On return, verify that attendance and leave records cover the actual dates of absence.

11. Leave Application and Approval Workflow

All planned leave should be submitted through the designated HR system. The request should identify the leave category, start date, end date, number of working days and a brief reason where the system requires one. Employees should not provide unnecessary personal or medical details in a general leave comment.

Step	Responsibility	Required action
1. Check	Employee	Review roster, available balance and any critical-period instructions.
2. Submit	Employee	Enter dates and leave category in the HR system before the absence where practical.
3. Review	Reporting manager	Check staffing, operational requirements, eligibility and overlapping leave.
4. Approve / return	Reporting manager	Approve, reject or return the request for clarification through the controlled system.
5. Record	HR / system	Update the leave balance and attendance status after the decision is recorded.
6. Handover	Employee	Share required work status, deadlines and contacts before planned extended leave.

For extended leave, the manager may require a handover note covering open tasks, critical deadlines, approvals in progress, key contacts and expected return date. Handover requirements do not change the employee's leave entitlement; they support continuity while the employee is away.

12. Approval Authority and Extended Absence

The reporting manager is the first-level approver for ordinary leave. Requests that exceed the manager's delegated authority, create a significant staffing impact or fall into an exception category are escalated to the designated department head and/or HR.

Request type	Primary approval	Additional review
Up to 3 working days	Reporting Manager	HR only where an exception or record issue exists
4–10 working days	Reporting Manager	Department Head may review operational impact
More than 10 working days	Department Head	HR review for eligibility, balance or special conditions
Leave Without Pay	Department Head	HR review and payroll impact confirmation
Policy exception	Authorized HR / management authority	Documented reason and approval required

These approval bands are administrative controls for the MedCore dataset. They do not override an employee's appointment terms or a separately approved HR arrangement.

13. Leave During Probation, Notice Period and Other Employment Statuses

Employees on probation remain eligible for leave according to their employment terms and the applicable category. Taking approved leave does not by itself establish or prevent confirmation. However, an extended absence may affect the manager's ability to complete a meaningful probation review, in which case HR may determine an appropriate review date under the onboarding process.

Employees serving notice remain subject to normal attendance and leave controls. Leave during notice should be requested through the same system and should not be treated as automatically approved merely because the employee has resigned. The appointment terms and HR's exit process determine any separate treatment of leave during the notice period.

Fixed-term employees follow the leave conditions applicable to their contract. When the contract end date falls near the end of the leave year, HR may conduct a final balance reconciliation rather than allowing leave assumptions to continue beyond the contractual end date.

14. Half-Day, Weekend and Holiday Treatment

Where the HR system permits half-day leave, a half-day is treated as 0.5 working day for balance purposes. The first or second half should correspond to the employee's approved working schedule.

Weekly offs and declared organizational holidays are not deducted from a leave balance when they fall inside an approved continuous leave period, unless a particular employee's roster treats that day as a scheduled working day. For shift employees, the roster is the controlling record.

If an employee is scheduled to work on a holiday or weekly off and requires absence, the employee must use the leave or authorized absence treatment applicable to that roster. Managers should not manually convert a scheduled working day into an off day without updating the approved schedule.

15. Attendance Correction and Regularization

Attendance correction is intended for genuine record errors, not as a substitute for obtaining leave approval. Common correction cases include a missed punch, incorrect shift mapping, system outage or an approved off-site assignment that was not reflected in the attendance system.

Correction reason	Typical evidence	Submission target
Missed entry / exit	Manager confirmation or work record	Within 2 working days

Correction reason	Typical evidence	Submission target
Roster mismatch	Approved roster / manager confirmation	Within 3 working days
System outage	System incident or administrator confirmation	Within 3 working days
Official off-site assignment	Assignment / manager approval	Within 3 working days
Leave approved but attendance absent	Approved leave request ID	Within 3 working days

Correction requests submitted after the target period may still be considered where the employee provides a reasonable explanation. Repeated late corrections may be reviewed as an attendance administration issue. HR may reject a correction where the evidence does not support the requested status.

16. Payroll Cut-Off and Attendance Reconciliation

Attendance and leave data are reconciled with payroll on a monthly cycle. For the MedCore framework, the payroll attendance cut-off is the 20th calendar day of each month for the current pay period. Corrections received after the cut-off may be reflected in the following payroll cycle unless HR and Finance are able to process the change before payroll closure.

Employees should review their attendance and leave records before the monthly cut-off. A payroll difference caused by a pending attendance correction should be raised with HR using the relevant date, leave request or correction reference. HR may coordinate with Finance where a correction changes a payroll input.

The attendance cut-off is an administrative processing rule and does not determine whether an employee was actually present or absent. The underlying approved record remains the basis for subsequent reconciliation.

17. Leave Without Pay and Negative Balances

Leave Without Pay may be approved when an employee has no applicable paid leave balance or when the circumstances fall outside the paid leave categories. LWP requires explicit approval and should not be created merely by allowing an employee's leave balance to become negative.

A negative leave balance is permitted only where HR has approved a documented exception. If an employee takes an absence without approval and has no applicable leave entitlement, the period may be treated as unauthorized absence pending review. Payroll treatment follows the final approved attendance and leave status.

Where an employee requests extended unpaid absence for personal reasons, the request should state the proposed dates and expected return. The approving authority should consider operational impact and any contractual or HR implications before confirming the arrangement.

18. Manager Responsibilities

Managers are responsible for applying the policy consistently within their teams and for ensuring that leave decisions are based on the employee's actual eligibility, roster and operational context.

- Maintain or validate accurate team rosters and communicate approved changes.
- Review leave requests within a reasonable administrative timeframe.
- Avoid asking employees to work while they are on approved leave unless an authorized change is made.
- Check attendance exceptions regularly rather than waiting for a payroll discrepancy.
- Confirm genuine attendance corrections with available work evidence.
- Escalate repeated unexplained absence, suspected falsification or policy exceptions to HR.
- Protect personal information contained in medical or leave records and share it only through authorized channels.

19. Employee Responsibilities

Employees are expected to manage their attendance records actively. This includes knowing the published roster, submitting leave requests accurately, communicating unexpected absence, checking balances and resolving attendance discrepancies promptly.

- Use only the employee's own attendance credentials.
- Do not assume that an unsubmitted or pending leave request is approved.
- Provide accurate dates and leave categories.
- Do not submit duplicate requests for the same absence unless HR instructs the employee to do so.
- Provide required evidence through the approved HR channel.
- Complete required handover before planned extended absence.
- Review the monthly attendance record and report discrepancies before payroll closure where possible.

20. Absence Escalation and Unauthorised Absence

An absence becomes an attendance concern when the employee has not established an approved leave or other authorized status for the scheduled period. The manager should first attempt reasonable contact and determine whether there is a genuine communication or emergency issue.

If the employee does not respond or the absence continues without an approved status, the manager should notify HR. HR may issue a formal request for clarification and document the employee's response. The classification of the absence and any corrective action should be determined only after the relevant facts and applicable employment terms are reviewed.

Repeated unauthorized absence, deliberate attendance falsification or misuse of the leave process may be handled under the applicable disciplinary framework. Managers should not make final disciplinary determinations informally through attendance comments.

21. Special Situations and Exceptions

Some situations require coordination across HR, the reporting manager and another function. Examples include prolonged medical absence, extended family emergencies, organizational closure, system-wide attendance outages, major roster changes and approved work arrangements that do not fit the normal attendance pattern.

An exception request should identify the employee, relevant dates, normal policy treatment, requested exception, reason at the level necessary for decision-making, and proposed approving authority. HR records the decision so that the same exception is not later interpreted as an automatic entitlement.

Where a special arrangement changes how attendance is recorded, the arrangement should state the recording method and review period. Informal flexibility that is not documented can create payroll and leave reconciliation problems and should therefore be regularized through the appropriate channel.

22. Leave Cancellation, Modification and Return to Work

An employee may request cancellation or modification of approved leave before or during the leave period where circumstances change. The employee should update the HR system rather than simply returning to work without changing the record.

If an employee returns earlier than planned, the manager should confirm the actual working date and HR should update the leave record. If the employee needs to extend leave, the extension should be requested before the original end date where reasonably possible. An extension is not approved until the relevant authority confirms it.

After a prolonged absence, HR or the manager may require a return-to-work confirmation to establish the actual return date and any approved work restrictions or arrangements. This administrative step is separate from the employee's leave balance.

23. Records, Confidentiality and Data Quality

Leave and attendance records are employment records and must be handled through controlled systems. Managers should not maintain unofficial spreadsheets containing detailed personal or medical information unless HR has specifically authorized the record.

Medical documentation should be shared only with the designated HR channel or authorized person. Managers generally need to know the approved work status and expected dates rather than detailed medical information. HR maintains the controlled record and applies access restrictions according to the organization's information-handling requirements.

Employees should report duplicate leave entries, incorrect balances, missing approvals and other data-quality problems. HR may correct system records after verifying the supporting evidence.

24. Policy Governance and Review

HR & Administration owns this policy and is responsible for maintaining the controlled version. The policy should be reviewed at least annually or earlier when there is a material change to attendance systems, organizational scheduling or internal leave administration.

Any exception must be documented by the authorized approving authority. An informal manager message does not permanently amend the policy. If another controlled document appears to conflict with this policy, employees should refer the matter to HR with the document names, versions and relevant sections so that the applicable rule can be confirmed.

Version changes should identify the effective date and the sections affected. Employees should use the current controlled copy rather than saved personal copies of earlier versions.

25. Quick Reference: Common Attendance and Leave Situations

Situation	What the employee should do
Planned vacation	Check balance and roster, submit Earned Leave request at least 7 calendar days in advance where practical, and wait for approval.
Sudden illness	Notify the manager as early as reasonably possible, submit Sick Leave, and provide required evidence if applicable.
Forgot to punch	Submit an attendance correction promptly with the actual timing and manager confirmation where required.
Need to leave early	Inform the manager before leaving and record the appropriate leave or authorized status.
Want to swap a shift	Obtain roster-owner approval before treating the exchanged shift as official.
Leave request rejected	Discuss the operational reason with the manager or approach HR if the rejection appears inconsistent with the controlled policy.
Leave balance appears wrong	Raise the issue with HR using the relevant dates and prior approved requests.
Absence extends beyond approved dates	Request an extension before the original end date where possible; do not assume it is automatically covered.
Returning earlier than planned	Inform the manager and update the leave record so the actual working date is captured.

26. Related HR Records and Systems

The Leave & Attendance Policy works with the employee master record, approved roster, attendance system, leave ledger, payroll inputs and related HR policies. The Employee Handbook provides the organization-wide employee framework, while this document is the detailed source for leave and attendance administration.

Questions about recruitment-stage joining conditions should be handled through the Recruitment & Onboarding Policy. Questions about employee benefits should be handled through the Employee Benefits Schedule. Performance concerns should be handled through the Performance Management Policy. Questions involving employee complaints, privacy or information security should be directed to the applicable controlled policy rather than resolved through attendance records.

27. Document Control

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